Contract Compliance Policy

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Section 1 Scope and Contract-Required Categories

This policy governs contract coverage for eligible purchase orders. In this MVP, the contract-required categories are IT Services and Professional Services. Other categories may use contracts, but absence of a contract alone is not a failure under this policy.

Section 4.1 Required Contract Coverage and Approved Exceptions

For an eligible purchase order dated on or after 2026-01-01 in IT Services or Professional Services, a valid contract at issuance is required unless a documented contract exception was approved by a DIRECTOR no later than issuance. The exception must be recorded for the purchase order before it is issued; a later approval does not cure missing coverage.

Section 4.2 Valid Contract Evidence

A valid contract is resolved to the purchase order, matches its supplier and category, covers the issuance date, and has not terminated on or before that date. An expired, terminated, mismatched, or unresolved contract reference is not valid contract coverage.

Section 5 Documentation and Escalation

The purchase record must preserve the contract reference or the documented exception and its approval timing. An unresolved reference or unavailable contract evidence requires review and investigation; it must not be treated as a confirmed absence. This policy does not treat supplier concentration as a contract violation.